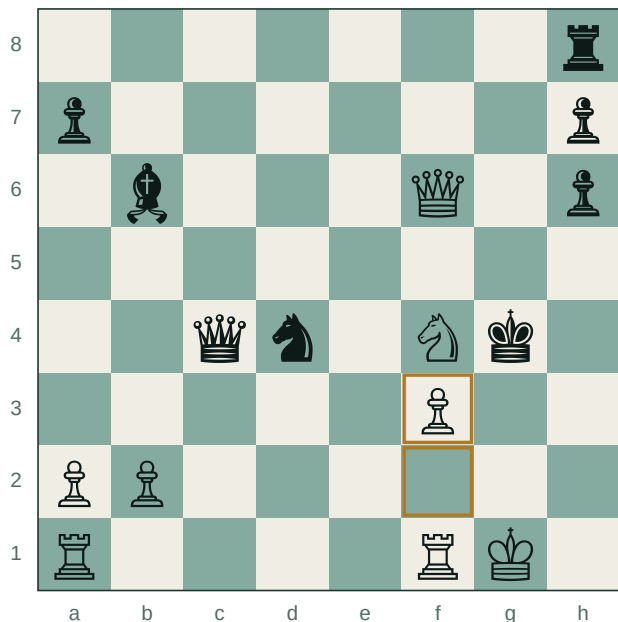


Double checks: Black, move 27

Double checks

Black to move



Previous move: 27.f3+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27...Nxf3+ 28. Kh1 Qxf4 29. Qxf4+ Kxf4

27...Nxf3+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The changed line means the bishop on b6 attacks the king on g1. Recorded reply: **28.Kh1**.

28...Qxf4 The queen captures the knight on f4. Recorded reply: **29.Qxf4+**.

29...Kxf4 The king captures the queen on f4.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on f6. Check for tactical protection.